

Activity 7 - Control the Pilot, Decide the Change and Close the Project

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 7 | Track Project Deliverables and Correct Misalignments Learning outcome: LO7 Duration: 105 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Kanban, Burndown, Budget, Control Chart and Retrospective templates

Objective

Track deliverables, monitor cost, schedule and resources, and correct misalignment (A7).

The situation

At the end of week 12, the baseline planned value is S\$108,000. Completed deliverables represent S\$90,000 of budgeted value and actual cost is S\$105,000. The sponsor also requests loyalty points, estimated at S\$24,000 and three weeks. Launch evidence is incomplete and the vendor wants final payment.

What you will do

Build an evidence-based status, calculate earned value, forecast outcome, analyse the change request, select corrective action, update approved baselines and complete acceptance, handover and lessons learned.

What you will produce

A current Kanban and burndown, earned-value analysis with forecasts, status report, change-control decision, corrective-action log, acceptance and handover checklist, lessons learned and closure recommendation.

Tool files in this folder

- [`tools/30 Kanban Board.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/31 Burndown Chart.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/32 Project Budget - Planned vs Actual - Weekly and Monthly.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/34 Control Chart.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/44 Agile Retrospective.xlsx`](#)

Data files

- [`data/control-input.csv`](#)

Step-by-step instructions

1. Update the Kanban board with each deliverable, owner, status, blocker, due date and acceptance evidence. Do not count work as Done without evidence.
2. Open the burndown template and plot remaining work by week. Identify any flat period, late cliff or scope increase.
3. Record PV = S\$108,000, EV = S\$90,000 and AC = S\$105,000. Calculate SV, CV, SPI and CPI.
4. Interpret each result in plain language. State separately whether the project is ahead/behind schedule and under/over cost for work performed.

5. Using $BAC = S\$162,000$, calculate EAC under current cost performance and ETC. Compare the forecast with the $S\$180,000$ authorised ceiling.
6. Prepare a one-page status: traffic light with threshold, variance cause, forecast, top risk/issue, corrective action, owner and decision needed.
7. Document the loyalty-points request: reason, scope, schedule, cost, resource, quality and risk impact; options; recommendation; and decision deadline.
8. Apply the change-control workflow. Decide reject, defer to a later phase, or approve with trade-off. Record the approver and rationale.
9. If approved, update the RTM, WBS, schedule, cost baseline, risk register and stakeholder communications. If rejected or deferred, update the decision log and expectations.
10. Select corrective action for current variance. Test schedule compression only on the current critical path and state the new risk introduced.
11. Use the control-chart template to show whether pick accuracy has stabilised at or above the 98% success threshold. Distinguish control limits from specification.
12. Complete acceptance evidence for the three outlets, training, support handover, data ownership, operational KPIs, unresolved items and final vendor payment.
13. Open the retrospective template. Record what worked, what failed, the root cause, recommendation and named owner for organisational follow-up.
14. Issue the closure recommendation only when acceptance, transition, contracts, records, lessons learned and benefits ownership are complete.

Evidence to submit

Complete [WORKSHEET.md](#) and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

Earned-value calculations and forecast reconcile; the change decision states complete impacts; corrective action has an owner and due date; and closure is supported by acceptance, handover, contract and lessons evidence.

Debrief

- Status reporting is a decision system: variance without forecast and action is only history.
- An approved change is not complete until every affected baseline and traceability record is updated.
- Project closure transfers accountability for benefits and operations; it does not merely stop project work.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 7. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.